James Praise

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Revenue and demand generation leader who has worked self-serve trial funnels and sales-led enterprise pipeline, and built the measurement that ties both to revenue. Work has contributed to $10M+ in qualified pipeline and 15+ product launches across B2B SaaS, cloud services and fintech companies, usually as the first or early marketing hire. More at jamespraise.xyz/work/aiven.

Selected Achievements:

- Grew qualified enterprise leads **40% quarter over quarter** at FunnelEnvy and lifted enterprise meeting bookings **31%** with account-based marketing.
- Ran cold outbound for five FunnelEnvy client accounts, averaging **$151,962 in pipeline created per client per month.**
- Repositioned Reform for technical and business buyers. **34% lift in trial activation, 21% lift in trial-to-paid conversion, 72% of legacy freemium users moved to paid plans.**
- Led revenue operations and go-to-market teams across five African countries as Chief Revenue Officer at Cecure Intelligence, a cloud solutions provider partnered with AWS, Google and Microsoft. **1,646 marketing qualified leads and $3.4M in open deals.**
- Built the cross-brand measurement stack for FunnelEnvy on GA4, Looker Studio, HubSpot and Lightdash, with **50% faster reporting.**

KEY SKILLS

Strategy: Demand Generation Strategy, Product-Led and Sales-Led Funnels, Ideal Customer Profile Definition, Budget Allocation, Attribution as a Decision Tool, Sales and Marketing Alignment.

Execution: Account-Based Marketing, Sales Plays, Field and Partner Marketing, Paid Media, Lifecycle Marketing, Competitor and Comparison Pages, Marketing Operations.

Tools: HubSpot, Salesforce, GA4, Looker Studio, Lightdash, Clay, n8n, Claude Code, Instantly, Smartlead, Google Ads, LinkedIn Ads, Meta Ads.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Growth, GTM & Demand Generation Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 to Apr 2026
FunnelEnvy (B2B, Revenue Funnel Optimization Service Provider)

- Set a quarterly demand generation roadmap across outbound, lifecycle and paid, with a 40% quarter-over-quarter increase in qualified enterprise leads.
- Built the Target Account Strategy and ABM Playbook. 31% lift in enterprise meeting bookings, 27% increase in outbound reply rates.
- Ran cold outbound for five client accounts at once. Average per client per month: 1,000 companies, 10 meetings held, $151,962 in pipeline created.
- Built the measurement stack across GA4, Looker Studio, HubSpot and Lightdash, with 50% faster reporting and better attribution accuracy.
- Drove 14% of new qualified pipeline from partnerships.
- Led the FunnelEnvy rebrand, including visual identity, brand style guide and sales deck system.

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 to Apr 2026
Reform (SaaS, MarTech, conversion-focused form builder)

- Repositioned Reform for a technical and business buyer. 34% lift in trial activation, 21% lift in trial-to-paid conversion.
- Moved 72% of legacy freemium users to paid plans.
- Launched integration and competitor pages that produced 19% more decision-stage leads.
- Built an AI-assisted SEO content engine with human review, reaching 100 articles a month and a 48% rise in non-branded organic traffic.
- Worked as the main in-house marketer, coordinating agencies and freelancers.

Founder & Builder | Marketing In Action | Apr 2024 to Present
Marketing In Action (Newsletter, Media, Academy, Community)

- Built the delivery system three specialists use to run client accounts, with review gates before anything goes live.
- Grew the newsletter to 5,000+ subscribers across 86 countries at a 47.5% average open rate.
- Use 82 agent skills for daily marketing work and publish 34 at github.com/realjaymes/marketingagentskills.
- Built a prospect and outbound engine and keep email sequences as code, with a person approving every change before it goes live.

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti (YC W23) | Sep 2023 to Feb 2024
Bujeti (SaaS, fintech, spend and expense management)

- 1,331 marketing qualified leads in 6 months and a 500% increase in new B2B customers.

- Built product marketing, lifecycle, events and partnership programs. 200+ qualified leads from events and partnerships.

Chief Revenue Officer | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 to Sep 2023
CIL (B2B, cloud solutions and technical training provider, Sub-Saharan Africa)

- Progressed from Sales Manager to Head of Growth & Marketing to Chief Revenue Officer.
- Led revenue operations and cross-functional go-to-market teams. 1,646 marketing qualified leads, 406 sales qualified leads, 629 demos booked, $3.4M in open deals.
- Launched the Academy across Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, Rwanda and Angola, with 10,000+ users in the first cohort.
- Delivered 3x return on investment on AWS-enabled solutions and built partnerships with AWS, Google and Microsoft.

Growth & Product Marketing Manager | Bento Africa | Jan 2022 to Dec 2022
Bento (payroll and HR software, fintech)

- Built a lead scoring system and nurture programs across multiple African markets. 50% more sales qualified leads and 25% more sales conversions.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation** | Miva Open University (2026)
- **Product Marketing PMMC Certification** | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
- **Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification** | Clay (2025)
- **BSc. Biochemistry** | University of Lagos (2018) | CGPA: 4.46/5.0